

Ry = Philosophy

ē = The

Q) Foundational Criteria in the Classification of Indian Philosophical Schools of Thought

* Introduction

- The term Indian Ry is synonymous with ē theory & practice known as Hinduism
- An adherent of this theory & practice is called a 'Hindu', a term derived from ē persian word "Hind."
- Hinduism is thus a theory, religion, culture and at the same time a philosophy of a group of people that dates back to 3,500 BCE.
- Their sacred text is called / known as ē Vedas
- The Vedas contains "bodies of knowledge" written between 1,500 and 800 BCE in Sanskrit (i.e. an ancient language).

* Indian Philosophical Doctrines (Tenets of Indian Ry)

- Hindu philosophical discourses emerged chiefly from 800 BCE to 200 CE
- It emphasizes the pantheistic notion of the divine reality that permeates the cosmos (i.e. Atman-Brahman)
- By Pantheistic notion it implies that God is everything, the universe is sacred because it is divine, that everything

in the universe is unity and that we are one with the cosmos. This is known as pantheism.

- The Atman Brahman refers to the self God, which is at the substrate of Hindu / Indian Py.
- There are 2 major school of thought in Indian Py, orthodox (āstika) and heterodox (nāstika)
- Orthodox: Sāṃkhya, Yoga, Nyāya, Vaiśeṣika, Mīmāṃsā and Vedānta.
- Heterodox: Jain, Buddhist, Ajīvika, Ajñāna & Cārvāka.

* Criteria for Orthodox School of Thought

3 major Criteria

1. Belief in 3 Vedas: a large body of religious texts originating in ancient India. Believe it as a useful source of knowledge. Authority.
2. Belief in afterlife and Devas: heavenly, divine beings of excellence, and also one of the terms for a deity in Hinduism.
3. Belief in the premises of the Brahman - i.e. highest universal principle, ultimate reality in the universe, the material, efficient, formal and final cause of all that exists / are

- Atman: inner self, spirit, / soul, is just principle or is true self of an individual, is essence of an individual.

The Atman is the self-God or our true and inner self, spirit, soul or the essence of an individual that lies at the inner core of our human identities, and it is only this inner core that is identical with God.

- The self-God is like the inner core of an onion, hidden beneath many distracting layers.

- By peeling away the outer layers of our identity, we discover the self-God within us and see the world's underlying unity.

A form of weak monism, a whole that is divided into parts.

- Plants, animals and everything else are united in the self-God which is beneath the physical structure of things. Central concern: relationship between Atman, Brahman and Prakriti.

* Criteria for Heterodox School of Thought

Existed in India before the 6th Century BCE.

Certain criteria are to be met or found before being called a heterodox and they include

1. Do not accept the authority of the Vedas, rather they anchor their teachings on non-vedic Sramanic traditions that promote liberty, suffering.

2. They do not believe in the premises of $\bar{e}$ atom
3. Their standpoints are opposed to atomism, materialism, atheism, agnosticism, freewill, extreme asceticism, strict ahimsa (strict principle of non-violence), and vegetarianism.

Philosophical traditions under this school of thought include Jainism, Cārvakas, Buddhism, Ajñanas, and Ājīvikas.

- ~~Agnostics~~ emphasize open mindedness, evidence-based reasoning & limitations of our knowledge (ie, inherent constraints on what we can know), and $\bar{e}$ knowability of certain truths

* Evaluation

- Oversimplification: Heterodox schools like Buddhism & Jainism have complex ppts that don't neatly fit just as vet-reject
- later indian ~~trends~~ thoughts eg Tantra, Bhakti blends ideas from both categories making rigid classification diff

* Conclusion

- A very useful historical & doctrinal tool for categ.
- Not to be seen as absolute as per say new trends about ~~new~~
- A more nuanced approach needed.

Confucianism focuses on humanistic values

* Introduction

Confucianism is an ancient Chinese philosophical and ethical system founded by Kong Fuzi (Confucius, 551 - 479 BCE). Unlike other religions and schools of thought that focus on deities / salvation, Confucianism focus on practical morality, social harmony and virtuous governance.

- make see am

* Tenets of Confucianism

- Confucius anchors his teachings on the Dao (ie $\bar{e}$ way of man, and $\bar{e}$ ancient sage-kings) and $\bar{e}$ De (ie, virtue)
- He underlines that imbibing those virtues (De) would restore and reformulate the li (rites and rituals) on a social and cultural level and reconstruct $\bar{e}$ world of human harmony and values.
- Mencius and Xun Zi applied $\bar{e}$ principles above.

* Ethical thoughts of Confucius

- Confucius believes that one can cultivate morals when one eschews vice and practices virtues, especially benevolence (kindness or compassion)

What this implies is that ethics for him is something practical and not mere theories.

Political Thought of Confucius.

Applying a notion of benevolence to politics, Confucius emphasized a relevance of benevolent government and virtuous rule.

He opposed a govt. which depended only on administrative decrees and punishment.

Epistemology of Confucius

C. admitted that some people were born with innate knowledge, which is accessible through deduction and intuition. This implies that the justification for innate knowledge is through deduction and intuition.

Intuition here refers to a vehicle of consciousness for an integrated grasp of reality.

The Metaphysics of Confucius

His metaphysics entails a dialectical understanding of reality as a dynamic presentation of events and things in a

universal interconnectedness.

- This means reality does not unfold in isolation for him.
- The central idea is creative change (yi, shengcheng), which manifests itself in a generation of life, in the transformation of states of beings & in a two modes of becoming - Yang & Yin, the invisible and the visible, the formless and the formed, the soft and the firm, the creative and the receptive.
- Transformation of things in the two modes of being is a subtle creative movement of reality in growth & decline, in an interchange of vital forces (qi), which also embodies relevant forms and principles (li).
- Any event is both phenomenal & noumenal.
- Q & A cannot be separated & their unity is realized in cosmological process also cosmologically understood.
- One can understand metaphysical principles of Confucianism on this onto-cosmological notion of consciousness.
- No why formal education is always essential for attainment of truth in Confu.
- "God" himself (conscious being / consciousness) is truth, so whatever it blesses reveals a qualities central to it, i.e. conscious which are in 3 layers.

* 3 layers of Consciousness

- Each of 3 layers of consciousness is interconnected.

* 1st layer: Cosmological

defines $\bar{e}$ objective world of being and becoming for the human person

→ 2nd - Consciousness of $\bar{e}$ human self:

provides a world of human distinction based on $\bar{e}$ self-refl. of $\bar{e}$ human mind and heart in which a human self can be uniquely identified in the life world of humanity

→ 3rd Layer - Political Conscion:

Na where $\bar{e}$ human self projects or reconstructs an ideal political and practical world of reality in which it realizes its desires for power, creativity and freedom of action.

- Hence, we may regard $\bar{e}$ 3 layers as forming an integral part of each other so that any human action and language imports and receives meaning relative to $\bar{e}$ 3.
- So, God in Confu be entity (ie that creative change) that is capable of integrating $\bar{e}$ 3 layers in its being.
- Hence we can reach eternal truth within this framework - Mencius
- So, consc. takes an active interest in $\bar{e}$ welfare & depth of humanity

- it also contains truth and establishes a true way of life that guides actions in everyday life
- Confucius is thus a way of life devoid of belief in an external God (conscious being)

* Evaluation

- Yes Supported
- Practical
- Humanism themes - benevolence
- Politics and governance
- Imbuing of De & issue of becoming
- Have had modifications

* Conclusion

- Chinese general humanistic undertone
- Made it unique

Rykal - Philosophical

(3) Yoga Conformity with Orthodox

* Introduction

- About Indian Classification and where Yoga belongs
- About Criteria

* Criteria for Orthodox

- The 3 major Criteria, - Vedas, Devas and Atman

* Rykal doctrine of Yoga

- notion of Self discipline
- The term Yoga
- Achievement of unity and discovery of self - Inner self.
- 2 major methods

* Methods

→ Yoga of selfless action (Karma)

- becoming indifferent to satisfaction gotten from actions (ie fruit)
- discover true inner self if we do away with $\bar{e}$ pleasures from actions
- When we do that, bring ourselves a step closer to ending the cycle of reincarnation
- That is by renouncing $\bar{e}$ fruit of ones actions, the person is infelicit is freed from $\bar{e}$ bond of birth and goes to a place devoid of illness (BG2)

→ Second Method (meditation) (raja)

- enables an agent to experience a union w self-God ^{Contemplative} ₂₀₀
- E practice requires a disciplined effort so BG give step by step inst.
- when u want to any find private spot, assume a seated posture, gaze ahead, subdue our thoughts our thoughts & senses and lose self-consciousness
- E self, harmonized by Yoga, sees E self abiding in all beings and all beings in E self (one sees E unity of E self in all things).

* Metaphy of Yoga

- Same dualist foundation as Samkhya
- According to E proponents, 2 realities make up E Universe in Yoga: Purusa (Consciousness) and Prakriti (matter) which gives rise to Jiva (a living being)

* Ethics

Basis of ethical theory of E Yoga school is on Yamas (right living in hindu yoga) and Niyama (positive duties/observances and elements of E Guna theory of Samkhya).

* Epistemology

- Accept 3 pramanas as only reliable means of getting knowledge as per Samkhya.
- 3P = Pratyaksha (perception) anumāna (inference) and Śabda (word/testimony of reliable sources)
- Each know is possible thru Yoga practice which is a path to Moksha (liberation)

* E Conformity

- Vedas comprises aporichade & BC, way they give guidelines & instruction to, teach! don't believe authority of vedas.
- Unity of inner self → Devas (principle of excellence)
- discover self - God - (atman) and unity with Brahman

* Evaluation

- No one of indian schools & sure, it concurs to its principles
- It is 3 principles
- It go hand in hand for orthodox and confirm 2 other principles.

* Conclusion

- We fit conclude say by - (list 3 principles) conform to the major criteria for orthodox schools

(4) Samkhya Similarities (metaph) with Jainism

* Introduction

- Talk about the schools of thought where they belong
- Talk about the metaph way you see & look into

* Samkhya School

- dualist by trad based on Samkhya-Karika (220-540CE)
the earliest surviving text of this thought school
- Present universe as
- Explore metaph, epistemic & ethics (say interest then) metaph

* Metaphysics

- Present universe as constituent of 2 independent realities
Purusa & Prakriti (existential form is susceptible to change)
- Prakriti can produce another thing / take another form of matter
- Both exist parallel to each other but born in living (jiva)
- Such fusion led to the emergence of intellect & ego (ahamkara)
- Also theory of gunas (innate tendencies). There are 3 modes of matter:
 - Guna of goodness, compassion, calmness & positivity (Sattva)
 - Guna of activity, chaos, passion & impulsivity, potential good or bad (Rajas)
 - Guna of darkness, ignorance, dullness, laziness, lethargy & negativity (Tamas)

- All matter has all 3 in diff. props with each being dominant at specific times of a day and its interplay define someone's character and determines life's progress
- Reject notion of created universe - No creative being
- Fundamental principle of reality as a way to liberation & right living

* Jainism

- heterodox
- differs from metaphysics from different angle

* Meta Physics of Jainism

- Transcendentalist undertone
- Two levels of existence - realm of living/conscious beings (Jiva) and non-living entities (Ajiva)
- Also in addition, maintain 2 ancient Gramanic traditions that co-existed with the Vedic tradition
- Uphold mind-body dualism & denies existence of a creative and omnipotent God.
- Teachings on liberation: You are 3 jewels - Right PY, Knowledge & Conduct

* Relatedness

- + Dualism: 2 fundamental constituents of reality
 - Purusa & Prakriti; Jiva & ajiva
 - Mind-body dualism
 - Liberation: Exploring fund. princ. of existence // 3 jewels
 - Uncreated Universe
 - Karmic action: Everything got in pay.

* Evaluation

- Mind body problem don't try
- So which way. They no just solve the problem
- Uncreated Universe bring up a new metaphor of causality,
- first causes
- So how then our universe came to be
- Modified to improve relevance in contemp. world.

* Conclusion

You don't see an *atman*?

6. Sankhya Epistemology

- human knowledge (jnana) is imperfect due to prejudice, our personalities, and $\bar{e}$ limitedness of our perception, which can only see one thing at a time and not everything
- The latter means that things are more than $\bar{e}$ way we perceive $\bar{m}$.
- One can overcome $\bar{e}$ ⁿ distorting prejudices when one becomes liberated (kaivalya, moksha) and more purified spiritually through self-discipline.
- Only then can one acquire $\bar{e}$ right kind of knowledge through $\bar{e}$ 3 pramanas (proofs), which are reliable ways of gaining knowledge.
- The 3 Ps
 - Pratyaksha (perception)
 - anumana (inference)
 - Sabda (aptavacana) i.e. word / testimony of reliable sources
- Sankhya school suggests that knowledge devoid of prejudices due to $\bar{e}$ discipline of $\bar{e}$ self is sufficient for moksha (liberation)

Nyaya Epistemology

* Nyaya

- term = justice, rules, method or judgement
- One of 6 orthodox
- Significant contribution to modern R_1 = systematic development of epistemology, logic, and methodology.

• Episte.

- = Accepts four pramans as reliable means of gaining K.
- Perception, Inference, word/testimony of past/present reliable experts and (ii) Comparison and analogy (Upamāna)
- Other pramānas: postulation, derivation from circumstances (Anvayavatti), and non-perception (negative/cognitive proof is a kind of realism) (Anupalavatti)

- Defend a form of philosophical realism i.e. things exist independent of our perception of them.
- We can't see a world in a mind, but there is a world that exists independent of a mind

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Carvaka Epistemology

- denies existence of deities
- Deny possibility of certainty in knowledge (ie a kind of loose sense of skepticism)
- It is loose b/c in away since it adopts perception as a means of knowledge
- Perception is the surest way of proving truth of anything
- Rejected in ference
- Westerners = realism & empiricism